

Cover Letter

I am writing to express my interest in the **Graduate Service Assistantship position with the Mississippi State University ITS Service Desk**. I am a graduate student in Computer Science with an M.S. in Computer Science from the University of Dayton, where I graduated with a 3.9/4.0 GPA. With more than four years of experience in software development, data science, machine learning, and technical problem-solving, I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to the ITS Service Desk while supporting the Mississippi State University community.

My academic and professional experience has provided me with a strong technical foundation and the ability to troubleshoot problems systematically. In my recent role as a Data Scientist at Lighthouse ERP, I developed Python- and Scikit-learn-based applications, built FastAPI REST services, worked with databases and large datasets, and developed analytics applications using React.js. This experience strengthened my ability to diagnose technical issues, understand software and system behavior, and communicate solutions clearly. I have also worked extensively with Python, MySQL, MongoDB, Microsoft Excel, Power BI, Tableau, Docker, and other software tools.

Previously, as a Data Analyst at HCLTech, I worked with large datasets, ETL processes, reporting systems, and cross-functional teams. This experience required careful attention to detail, effective communication, troubleshooting, and timely resolution of technical and data-related issues. My experience collaborating with different teams has also helped me develop the interpersonal skills necessary to assist users with varying levels of technical knowledge.

I am particularly interested in the ITS Service Desk position because it combines **technical support, problem-solving, communication, and service to the university community**. I would be eager to assist students, faculty, and staff with issues involving email, Canvas, network connectivity, Duo, myState/Banner, software installation, and other university technology services. I am also comfortable learning new systems and technologies quickly and would be glad to support classroom technology and other ITS activities as needed.

In addition to my professional experience, my graduate education has strengthened my programming, algorithms, operating systems, computer vision, deep learning, and data science knowledge. My research interests in machine learning, cybersecurity, anomaly detection, and intelligent systems have further developed my analytical and problem-solving abilities. I believe these skills, combined with my willingness to learn and help others, would allow me to be an effective member of the ITS Service Desk team.

I would greatly appreciate the opportunity to contribute to Mississippi State University ITS as a Graduate Service Assistant. I am confident that my technical background, communication skills, and commitment to providing reliable support would make me a strong candidate for this position. Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my background and skills can contribute to the ITS Service Desk.

Sincerely,
Priya Ajay Deshmukh

